

Ashlyn Dsilva

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Summary

Frontend Developer specializing in React and Next.js, with hands-on experience building and owning production frontends from scratch. Designed a client-side XPath-based DOM extraction engine that cut API response times from 60–120s to under 30s, architected a config-based UI system for multi-platform RSS feed generation, and implemented SSR for improved discoverability. Strong in state management, complex browser APIs, and scalable component design. Comfortable owning the full frontend of a product end-to-end in lean team environments.

Technical Skills

Frontend: React.js, Next.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, Redux, Redux Toolkit, SCSS (SASS), Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, Responsive Design

Backend & APIs: REST API Integration, Server-Side Rendering (SSR)

Architecture: Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), DOM Manipulation, Scalable Component Design, Config Driven Components

Tools: GitHub

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library (RTL) (*working knowledge*)

Experience

Frontend Developer

FeedSpot

July 2024 – Present

FeedSpot Reader

Production RSS reader for aggregating blogs, news, and podcasts — actively maintained

- Refactored a 3000+ line monolithic sidebar component into modular callbacks, fixed broken URL param propagation to Redux-managed routing, and added an abort controller to cancel redundant in-flight requests — reducing unnecessary backend calls and improving navigation reliability.
- Extended the legacy sidebar with several new features: show more/less logic for folders and feeds exceeding 50 items, unread-first visibility sorting, and an auto-open folder system driven by a backend isOpen flag — all requiring a new Redux state flow to maintain persistence across multiple sidebar instances and prevent redundant API calls on re-render.
- Built a text highlighting system by traversing rendered DOM content and mapping browser selection ranges to structured data, ensuring precise and reliable annotations across complex, dynamic layouts.
- Designed and implemented a fully animated onboarding wizard — carousel-style navigation using index-driven key reflows to trigger CSS transitions, API-dependent sections that fade in on resolution, and a final fade-out into the reader view. Independently added polish including a confetti success state and directional micro-animations throughout.
- Introduced stagger, opacity, and expand animations across list, card, and magazine views, and applied fade-in transitions to API-dependent elements — replacing abrupt renders with a consistently smooth, refined feel throughout the product.
- Resolved cross-component sync issues in legacy code by passing callbacks through Redux state or propagating Redux actions to keep global and page-specific components in sync.
- Onboarded 3 new developers by explaining codebase structure, workflows, and architectural decisions; conducted code reviews and shared best practices to maintain code quality and

consistency.

FeedSpot RSS Builder → RSS Feeds

Tool for generating custom RSS feeds from websites and social platforms — actively maintained and scaled

- Built the complete frontend from scratch — owning all UI, state management, component architecture, and micro-interactions — for a tool actively used in production at scale. Initially collaborated with a senior developer on the UI; took full ownership of the frontend thereafter.
- Designed and implemented a content extraction system using iframe event handling and DOM parsing. Migrated grouping logic from a backend CSS classname-based approach to client-side XPath-based DOM analysis, improving grouping accuracy from ~5/10 to ~9/10 and reducing API response time from 60–120 seconds down to 20–30 seconds.
- Architected a config-based UI system to support RSS feed generation across multiple social platforms (Instagram, X, LinkedIn), unifying shared component logic through configuration rather than duplication — significantly reducing development time and JSX overhead for new platform additions.
- Led the expansion from RSS Builder to the broader RSS Feeds product, delivering new UI screens and landing page sections while maintaining a lean two-person team structure (frontend + backend). Build quality was high enough that the backend developer used the live frontend for endpoint testing in place of Postman.

FeedSpot Teams

Collaboration platform — built during the initial onboarding phase

- Implemented a multi-layered RBAC system driven by API preferences: route guards restricting access to Teams pages for non-subscribers, conditional sidebar sections, and granular action-level restrictions across three roles (owner, admin, member) and sub-roles such as pinboard admins with scoped edit, delete, and member management permissions.
- Proposed and implemented URL-based tab navigation for the Teams page — building on a prior URL param fix to the codebase — allowing users to deep-link directly to any section rather than always entering through the default tab.
- Built shared pinboards with minute-interval polling to detect new updates, surfacing an in-app notification badge to prompt users to reload and receive new entries without a full page refresh.
- Built collaborative annotation features that sync on in-app or page refresh.
- Navigated and extended a large legacy codebase across all Teams features while maintaining system stability.

Education

B.E. in Computer Engineering

Jan 2021 – Jun 2024

St. Francis Institute of Technology, Borivali

CGPA: 8.98

Final Year Project: UniXplore

Developed an Android application to recommend universities based on user preferences, using vector representations and cosine similarity for scoring.